

Mingyue Zha

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EDUCATION

Dartmouth College

B.A. Quantitative Social Science (Psychology Concentration), GPA: 4.00/4.00

- Minors in Neuroscience & Chemistry, Premed Track

Hanover, NH

Sep. 2023 – Jun. 2027

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Stamps Scholar Research (advised by Prof. Herbert Chang & Yusaku Horiuchi) Apr. 2025 – Present

Dartmouth College

Hanover, NH

- Awarded Stamps Scholarship (\$20,000) to conduct independent research on mental health and digital platforms
- First study used visual and large language processing to examine social anxiety content on 400,000+ videos; Second study examined geographic and linguistic inequalities of AI health overviews on search engines; Currently conducting senior thesis

Visiting Researcher, Digital Mental Health Lab (advised by Dr. Amy Orben) Jun. – Sep. 2026

University of Cambridge

Cambridge, UK

- Analyzed relationship between social media beauty content exposure and adolescent body image using social media watch histories and ecological momentary assessments donated by UK adolescents
- Supported policy-facing work and evidence synthesis on youth digital wellbeing, presented rapid evidence review on age of smartphone acquisition and impact on youth mental health and academic attainment to UK Department of Education

Quantitative Social Science Researcher (advised by Prof. Herbert Chang) Sep. 2023 – Apr. 2025

Dartmouth College

Hanover, NH

- Co-authored four papers examining digital mental health, gender equity, artificial intelligence, and political discourse using social network analysis, evolutionary game theory, sentiment analysis, and LLM-based analysis
- Presented lead-author research at six top computational social science conferences, including the Intl. Conference on Computational Social Science, Intl. Conference on Web and Social Media, and Intl. Communication Association Conference

Research Assistant, AI & Mental Health Lab (advised by Dr. Michael Heinz) Sep. 2023 – Sep. 2024

Geisel School of Medicine

Hanover, NH

- Conducted structured clinical interviews with patients diagnosed with mood and cannabis use disorders to evaluate the clinical effectiveness of AI-assisted psychotherapy
- Wrote 300+ rounds of training dialogue for a cognitive behavioral therapy AI model; evaluated and gave feedback on other lab members' training dialogue; contributed to literature review and data collection on digital mental health interventions

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Co-Founder & Vice President, FORT Jan. 2026 – Present

501(c)(3) Mental Health Nonprofit

Northeast US

- Co-founded a nonprofit expanding access to youth mental health care across the Northeast; fundraised \$20,000+ in our first year and providing financial assistance to youths, covering costs of therapy and mental health treatments
- Coordinating volunteers and educational programming to increase awareness of mental health and wellbeing

President, Mental Health Union Mar. 2025 – Present

Dartmouth College

Hanover, NH

- Creating Dartmouth's Mental Health First Aid (MHFA) course, a 3-week course certifying 100 students in MHFA each year
- Established MHU's policy division, which meets with Student Government and administrators to offer feedback on wellness policies and advocate for students, such as expanding grief counseling and creating residential counseling offices

Co-President & Executive Member, Nathan Smith Pre-Health Society Mar. 2024 – Present

Dartmouth College

Hanover, NH

- Organize academic and professional opportunities, including guest speaker panels, case studies, and networking events for Nathan Smith Society, Dartmouth's pre-medicine, pre-veterinary, and pre-dental society comprising 1,200+ members
- Coordinate Medicare and AI Scholars Program, informing students of risks and opportunities with AI integration into healthcare

HEALTHCARE EXPERIENCE

Medical Assistant Jan. 2026 – Present

Dartmouth Hitchcock Medical Center, Ophthalmology Clinic

Hanover, NH

- Perform visual exams and clinical workups including refraction and applanation, document patient information, and assist with treatment planning; Provide care and support to elderly patients from communities across the Northeast

Health Sector Financial Analyst Sep. – Dec. 2025

Tuck Advisors

Solebury, PA

- Supported client presentations and strategic recommendations for an M&A firm advising social enterprises in healthcare and health technology across North American, European, and Middle Eastern health sectors
- Named Top Intern of the cohort and was sole recipient of a Senior Analyst return offer, which I declined

Health Tech Intern

Aug. – Dec. 2025

Health Tech Without Borders

Boston, MA

- Conducted research and product development for an AI-powered nutrition platform supporting postpartum women in the Philippines, including market analysis, expert interviews, UI, and prototype design
- Contributed to two white papers on clinician skepticism of emerging technologies and digital tools

Emergency Room Volunteer

Jun. 2024 - Sep. 2024

Yale New Haven Hospital, Emergency Department

New Haven, CT

- Supported patient care by taking vital signs and histories, transporting patients, and facilitating patient communication
- Shadowed physicians and nurses across trauma, acute illness, resuscitation, and end-of-life care, gaining firsthand exposure to emergency medicine and the importance of compassion in high-stress clinical settings

MENTORSHIP EXPERIENCE

Senior Academic Mentor

Sep. 2026 – Present

Dartmouth College

Hanover, NH

- One of 10 seniors hand-selected by academic deans to mentor incoming first-year students through their transition to Dartmouth
- Hold one-on-one office hours helping students in course selection advising, resource navigation, and community-building

Global Health Fellow

Sep. 2024 – Present

Dickey Center for International Understanding

Hanover, NH

- Planned, organized, and moderated a 3-day visit with Dr. Jim O'Connell, founder of Boston Healthcare for the Homeless Program, for Upper Valley health organizations; attending workshops and panels to discuss global health issues and solutions

Teaching Assistantships

Sep. 2024 – Jun. 2025

Dartmouth College

Hanover, NH

- Guided 25 students from foundational Python programming to conducting research in QSS 20, Modern Statistical Computing
- Led discussion sections, held office hours, and graded exams for 200 students in MUS 46, Video Games and the Meaning of Life, an interdisciplinary course on music, media, and philosophy

PUBLICATIONS

- **Zha, M.** & Chang, H.C.H. (2026). Mental Health Discourse on TikTok: Interpreting Multimodal Short-Form Videos at Scale. *Proc. ICWSM Workshop on Digital Minds*. AAAI Press. (Peer-reviewed)
- Chang, H.C.H., Shaman, B., Chen, Y.C., **Zha, M.**, Noh, S., Wei, C., Weener, T., & Magee, M. (2026). The Meme Is the Message: Generative Memes and AI Visuals in the 2024 USA Presidential Elections. *Proc. ICWSM*, 20(1), 435–451. (Peer-reviewed)
- **Zha, M.** & Chang, H.C.H. (2025). Gender Inequalities in Content Collaborations. *Proc. ICWSM Workshop on Cyber Social Threats*. AAAI Press. (Peer-reviewed)
- Chang, H.C.H., Weener, T., Chen, Y.C., Noh, S., **Zha, M.**, & Lo, H. (2025). Do Language Models Favor Their Home Countries? Asymmetric Propagation of Positive Misinformation and Foreign Influence Audits. *HKS Misinformation Review*, 6(5). (Peer-reviewed)
- **Zha, M.** & Chang, H.C.H. (2026). Geographical Inequality of AI Overviews for Health. *Submitted, PNAS Nexus*.
- Haag, C., **Zha, M.**, & Orben, A. (2026). Exposure to Idealized Appearance Content on Social Media and Body Satisfaction in Female Adolescents. *Submitted, Nature Human Behaviour*.
- Chang, H.C.H., **Zha, M.**, Noh, S., Chen, Y.C., Shaman, B., Wei, C., Weener, T., & Magee, M. (2024). Visual Politics: TikTok versus Instagram in the 2024 US Presidential Election. *arXiv:2403.03224*. (Non-referred)
- Cheng, W. & **Zha, M.** (Illustrator). *Symphonics*. University of Chicago Press, forthcoming 2027. (Non-referred book)

HONORS AND AWARDS

- **Philanthropic Grant of the Class of 1969** (\$10,000, 2026) – competitive grant awarded to one student-led initiative each year; funding is going to Mental Health First Aid initiative
- **Stamps Scholarship** (\$20,000, 2025) – competitive, merit-based scholarship funding two years of independent, faculty-mentored research on digital platforms and health. One of 247 students selected from 413,000+ applicants.
- **Top Paper Award, International Communication Association** (2025) – top-paper honor for first-author research on mental health and gender inequality in online communities
- **Neukom Institute Outstanding Research Prize** (\$750, 2025) – Dartmouth prize recognizing outstanding undergraduate research in computational science
- **Phi Beta Kappa Sophomore Prize** (2025) – awarded to sophomores in top 5% of class, 4.00 GPA
- **James O. Freedman Presidential Scholar** (\$3,400, 2025) – Competitive research award for students in the top 35% of their class, funding independent undergraduate research
- **Neukom Scholar** (\$3,400, 2024) – Research fellowship supporting undergraduate computational research
- **URAD Scholar** (\$3,400, 2024) – Undergraduate research stipend supporting faculty-mentored research with Dr. Michael Heinz
- **Chia Family Foundation Scholarship** (2023-2026) – scholarship supporting Chinese-American students in higher education

HOBBIES AND INTERESTS

Classical Pianist & Digital Illustrator

- Developing *Seasons of Love*, a classical piano senior recital, through Dartmouth's Independent Instructor Music Program
- Serving as lead illustrator and collaborator for *Symphonics*, a book on musical improvisation, by Professor William Cheng